

judiciary's verdict in the Shah Bano case, proved that he too was not averse to using the communal demon for his survival. Congress and ideology have always been bi-polar opposites and will always remain so.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN,
Coimbatore

Politicians do make strange bedfellows. Power corrupts and corrupted people stick together for the sake of corrupted survival.

DOMINIC AYYANIKATT,
on e-mail

In Good Humour

The article on democracy was the best ("Many and Merry", August 20). The contrast brought out between the robotic, monotonous "harmony" of the Finns and the vibrant diversity of the Indians, livened by piquant humour was very vivid that made up for some good reading.

VIMALA RAMU, on e-mail

Poor Rich Country

Superpower India is still to cater to the needs of the common man ("Enchantment of Riches", August 20). Despite 9 per cent growth, 75 per cent people in the country survive on Rs 80 per day, while 50 per cent children have no access to education.

VITULL K. GUPTA, Bhatinda

Just for Jest

The magazine sure knows how to tickle the funny bone ("The Alphabet of Unity", August 20). Another addition can be made to the list: B for baba. One can find a baba

within a radius of every few kilometres in India. There is no problem that a baba cannot solve.

SOM SHARMA, Gurgaon

All for Vote-game

Political parties are more worried about Muslim votes than the security of the country ("Cross-party Hero", August 20). How else can one explain the reception that rabble rousing cleric Abdul Nasser Madani got?

A. SRIKANTIAH, Bangalore

Lost Values

Gandhi seems to have become synonymous with love because we portray whatever we miss the most in our movies, novels and plays ("From Saint to Star", August 20). However, we are depicting Gandhi and love without the two ruling even an iota of our hearts. It is a perfect case of "much ado about nothing".

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

SCAMS GALORE



Ashok Malhotra's case proves that even though one may sell chhole, chaat or fruits, the best way to earn money is to have close connections with politicians and VIPs ("Serving Scam on a Platter", August 20).

MAHESH KUMAR, Delhi

The land scam, involving a number of politicians, has come as a final nail in the coffin of Delhi Chief Minister Sheila Dixit. With rising factionalism in the Delhi Congress, the uproar over the sealing issue and now this scam, she will find the going tough to handle in the assembly elections next year.

SHIKHAR BHATNAGAR, on e-mail

Malhotra, though the kingpin of the scam, has been the only person named so far. What about spilling the beans on the names of the politicians involved too?

ANURAG TRIPATHI, Delhi

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

SEPTEMBER 1-15, 1977



Filmy Capers

Although the national awards have been an annual feature since 1953, little has been done, over the years, to set standards of excellence by rationalising the categories. This year, for instance, there was provision for 16 national and 15 regional awards in the feature film category.

To this were added nine awards for short films. In a country that produces Film Marathi films of a remarkably poor standard on the whole, it would seem that the plethora of awards is intended not so much as an encouragement to those doing good work but as a gesture to pacify all sections of the industry, good, bad and indifferent. Take the category of the "best feature film with mass appeal, wholesome entertainment and aesthetic value". This award has been introduced to conciliate those who churn out commercial extravaganzas by the dozen every year.

—Bindu Batra

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday-Friday; 10am-6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com